Year 1 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Same content as version 1. Use with `Y01/Y01_Student_Booklet_v3.1`; do not mix versions.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y01_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

For a child joining **Year 1** (about 5 years old). Most have finished the middle year of a Chinese kindergarten (中班); some come from bilingual kindergartens. The visit takes **about 45 minutes, 1:1**, and should feel like play. The child uses the Year 1 student booklet; you write the maths marks in the mark boxes on the child's pages and record everything else on the child's grading sheet, Reading front sheet and Interview sheet.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Student booklet	These instructions
1	Welcome	1	Assessor		page 1 (you write the child's name)	Section 2
2	Speaking: picture talk	4	Assessor		page 2	3.1
3	Listening: follow instructions (recording)	about 4	Assessor	crayons: red, blue, yellow, green	page 3	3.2
4	Reading: Early Reading Screen, then Graded Sentence Reading Screen	12	Assessor	shared cards, Early Reading Screen record sheets, Reading front sheet, levelled books, plain card	(separate cards)	3.3
5	Movement break	2	Assessor	water		Section 2
6	Maths	12	Assessor	20 counters	pages 4 to 11	Section 4
7	Writing	5	Assessor	pencil	pages 12 and 13	3.4
8	Play-based interview and goodbye	6	Interviewer (often the assessor)	crayons, Interviewer guide, Interview sheet	page 14	Section 5
	Total	**about 45** (43 minutes of tasks, plus the welcome and break)				

The order follows the blueprint for Years 1 to 3. These instructions put all the English tasks together in Section 3, so **writing (3.4) comes after maths on the day**.

What to print

For each candidate:

- Year 1 student booklet: A4, single-sided, in colour if possible (the pictures also work in greyscale)
- the grading sheet (`Y01/Y01_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`)
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`)
- the Interview sheet (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y1_Y2`)
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`)
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`), completed after the visit
- the Early Reading Screen record sheets (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Record`): only the sheets you expect to use

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y1_Y2`)
- the Sentence Reading Guide (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`)
- the Graded Sentence Reading Screen card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`)
- the Early Reading Screen cards (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Cards`) and guide (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Guide`)
- levelled reading books (`01_Reading_Books_and_Materials`)
- 20 counters, all the same colour and size (about 2 cm across), in a small pot
- 4 crayons (red, blue, yellow, green), 2 pencils, a rubber
- a plain card about A5 size (to cover pictures and sentences), a watch or timer

2. Before you start

The room. Use a low table. Sit beside the child at a corner of the table, not opposite. Keep the counters and crayons out of sight until each task needs them. A young child is never alone with one adult behind a closed door: keep the door open or have a second adult in the room. Show the child where the parent will wait. If the child will not separate, the parent may sit quietly at the back without helping; note it on the grading sheet.

Pace of speech. Year 1 students are still learning English: speak slowly and clearly, in short phrases, with a pause of about a second after each phrase. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared (do not slow down further for a child who finds it hard, and repeat an instruction only where these instructions allow it). The listening recording is paced the same way: a clear, steady voice with a pause of about a second after each phrase.

Welcome (1 minute). Say:

> "Hello! My name is [your name]. What's your name?" (wait) "Hello, [name]. How old are you?" (wait) "Today we are going to look at some pictures, play some games, count and draw. Some things are easy and some things are tricky. That's OK. Just try your best."

Write the child's name on the cover of the student booklet yourself (the child writes their name later, in the writing task). Note how the child first responds (English, Chinese, gesture, silence): it is early evidence for speaking and listening.

Access rules for Year 1

	English tasks: picture talk, listening, reading, writing	Maths
What you may say	Only the words in the script. Do not explain words, translate, point or show what to do. You may repeat an instruction once if the child asks or clearly did not hear: tick **R** on the grading sheet.	Any question, in English, as often as needed. You may point to the picture and show with counters.
Chinese	Not used by you.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the child cannot follow the English after you have read it aloud, the colleague may say the question once in Chinese. Mark the item **L** and list it on the grading sheet. The mark still counts.
Answers	English words, pointing and doing count. An answer in Chinese scores 0.	Pointing, fingers, counters and number words in English all count. An answer in Chinese scores 0.
Not yet taught		If the child or parent tells you the child has not met an idea, mark **NT**. It scores 0; list it on the grading sheet. Five year olds rarely say this themselves, so otherwise score 0 and add a note on the grading sheet.

Codes on the grading sheet: **R** instruction repeated once; **L** language support in maths; **NT** not yet taught. Extra time, a reader or extra breaks for a known need are allowed: record them on the grading sheet. Wherever these instructions say "note it", write the note in the comment space on the grading sheet.

Keeping the child at ease

- Praise effort, never correctness: "You are working hard!", "Thank you!", "Good listening!" Use the same warm tone after right and wrong answers. Never say "No" or "Wrong", and do not correct.
- A silent child is common: many young children new to English go through a silent period. Smile, wait, move on. Pointing tasks still work. Never pressure the child.
- If the child is tired, take a short extra break. If the child becomes upset, stop, comfort them and let them go to the parent. Try again later if they recover; otherwise end the visit and record what was done on the grading sheet.

Stopping rules

Task	Stop when
Picture talk	the child has not answered three prompts in a row. Finish with an easy "What's this?" so the child ends with success.
Listening	three items in a row score 0. Score the rest 0.
Reading screens	as the Early Reading Screen guide and the Sentence Reading Guide say.
Maths	three items in a row score 0 in Section A: go on to Section B, which starts easy again. Three in a row score 0 in Section B: stop.
Writing	the child says they cannot do more after one encouragement ("Have a go. Write the sounds you can hear.").

Movement break (about 2 minutes, after reading). Say: "Let's have a break! Stand up. Stretch up high. Touch your toes. Jump three times. Now sit down." Do the actions with the child. It is not scored. Offer water and the toilet.

3. English

3.1 Speaking: picture talk (4 minutes, student booklet page 2)

The picture shows a windy day in a park: the wind is blowing a girl's balloon away and she is sad because she cannot reach the string; a boy has thrown a ball and a dog is running after it; two ducks swim on a pond; the sun is out and leaves blow in the wind.

How. Open the booklet at page 2. Give the prompts in order, slowly and clearly (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2). Wait about 5 seconds after each one; if there is no answer, go on to the next prompt. You may repeat a prompt once.

Do not name things for the child or finish their sentences. Record what the child says on the grading sheet, as close to their words as you can ("dog run", "she sad balloon fly").

Step	Say	Listen for
1 Open	"Look at this picture. What can you see?"	Any naming: tree, balloon, girl, boy, dog, ball, duck, pond, sun, cloud, bird, flower
2 Naming	Point to each and ask "What's this?": the dog, the ball, the balloon, a duck	dog, ball, balloon, duck. Count how many the child names in English (out of 4) and record it
3 Action	Point to the dog. "What is the dog doing?"	running, chasing the ball, playing
4 Action	Point to the boy. "What is the boy doing?"	throwing the ball, playing with the dog
5 Feeling	Point to the girl. "How does she feel?"	sad, unhappy, crying, upset, cross
6 Explaining	"Why?"	her balloon is flying away; the wind blew it; she can't reach the string
7 Telling	"Tell me what is happening in the picture."	joined ideas: "The girl's balloon is flying away and the dog is running after the ball."
8 Predicting	"What do you think will happen next?"	the balloon will fly up to the clouds or get caught in the tree; the boy will try to catch it; her mum will buy a new one; the dog will catch the ball
9 Personal	"Do you like the park? What do you do at the park?"	talks about their own life

Speaking band at age 5 (examples from this picture)

Band	What it sounds like at age 5	Example
A New to English	Silent, nods or points; perhaps one or two English words; may speak in Chinese	points to the dog; "狗"; "dog"
B Early acquisition	Names several things in English; single words and two-word phrases; little description	"dog", "ball", "a duck", "balloon fly"
C Developing competence	Short sentences with a verb, often with errors; can say what someone is doing	"The dog is run." "She sad." "Boy throw the ball."
D Competent	Connected sentences; explains with "because"; tells the picture as a little story; errors do not get in the way	"She is sad because her balloon fly away." "Maybe the boy help her."
E Fluent	Talks as a fluent English-speaking 5 year old does: full sentences, words such as blowing, chasing, windy, reach, and ideas of their own	"The wind blew her balloon away and she can't reach the string. I think it will go up to the clouds, and her mummy will buy her a new one."

Give the speaking band from the picture talk on the grading sheet. The final speaking band is the best fit of the picture talk and the interview (Section 5), and is given on the Interview sheet.

What to look for

- A strong response needs few prompts, joins ideas (and, because, then) and predicts ("maybe", "I think"). A weak one needs every prompt and gives one word or repeats your question.
- Do not count against the child: missing -s, -ed, "a" and "the"; "he" and "she" mixed up; accent features (l and r, light final consonants). These are normal for learners.
- A child who names little in English but, as the parent describes, talks well in Chinese has an English barrier only. A child who says very little in either language may need a speech and language check: see the Interviewer guide and the Interview sheet.

3.2 Listening: follow instructions (about 4 minutes with the recording, page 3)

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y01/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script.

Set up. Open the booklet at page 3 (the bedroom). Put the four crayons on the table: red, blue, yellow and green. Do not name the colours.

Say: "Let's play a listening game. Look at this picture. Listen carefully and do what I say. Ready?" Practice, not scored: "Put your finger on the picture." (Smile.) "Good!"

Rules

- Say each instruction **once**, slowly and clearly, with a pause after each phrase (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2). Look at the child, not at the picture: children follow your eyes. Do not point, nod or gesture.
- If the child asks, or clearly did not hear, you may say it once more: tick **R** on the grading sheet. A correct response after one repeat still scores.
- With the recording, if the child asks, or clearly did not hear, pause, go back to the start of the item (the start times are in the read-me) and play it once more: tick **R** on the grading sheet. Pause the recording while a child is still working on an item.
- For colouring, a small mark of the right colour on the right thing is enough. Say "Just a little bit of colour is fine" if the child starts colouring carefully.
- **Score 1** only when every part is right, and in the right order where the instruction says "then" or "before". Otherwise 0. No half marks.
- Stop after three 0s in a row.

No.	Say	Type	Correct response
1	"Point to the cat."	one step	the cat on the rug
2	"Point to the window."	one step	anywhere inside the window frame (the sun or cloud seen through it is fine)
3	"Point to the ball under the bed."	position: under	the ball under the bed, not the ball on the chair
4	"Point to the book next to the lamp."	position: next to	the book standing on the desk beside the lamp, not the books on the shelf
5	"Point to the toy between the car and the boat."	position: between	the toy duck on the top shelf
6	"Point to the teddy, then point to the shoes."	two steps	the teddy on the bed, then the shoes on the floor, in that order
7	"Colour the lamp yellow and colour the boat blue."	two steps	yellow on the lamp and blue on the boat (either order)
8	"Draw a circle round the clock, then colour the ball on the chair red."	two steps	a circle round the clock, then red on the ball on the chair (not the ball under the bed)
9	"Before you colour the car green, point to the bed."	sequence: before	points to the bed **first**, then colours the car green
10	"If there is a moon in the window, colour it yellow. If there is a sun in the window, draw a circle round it."	condition: if	draws a circle round the sun in the window and does not colour it (there is no moon)

Total: 10 marks (1 for each item).

Band guide (Year 1)

Score	0 to 2	3 to 4	5 to 6	7	8 to 10
Listening band	A	B	C	D	E

What to look for

- Items 1 and 2 need everyday nouns; 3 to 5 need the position words under, next to and between; 6 to 8 need the child to hold a longer piece of English in mind; 9 and 10 need grammar ("before", "if").
- Right object, wrong colour: score 0, but note it. Colour words may be the only gap.
- A child who does only the first part of every two-step item is probably holding too much new English at once, not showing a memory difficulty. A child who answers quickly and correctly but watches your face closely may be using your eyes as clues: keep looking at the child.

3.3 Reading: Early Reading Screen and Graded Sentence Reading Screen (12 minutes)

Use the Early Reading Screen (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Cards` and the record sheets in `shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Record`) starting at the letter sounds (Card 1, then Card 2 if 15 or more of Card 1 are right) and then the Section 1 words (Year 1 start point in the guide, Section 2); and the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, with the rules in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide` and the score grid on the Reading front sheet) starting at Level 1.

The full scripts and rules for the Early Reading Screen are in `shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Guide`. Follow the scripts, scoring and stopping rules in that guide and in the Sentence Reading Guide; these instructions have no reading tasks of their own. All answers are in English, including the answers to the questions about what the child has just read. Many children starting Year 1 read very little English, and many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points on the sentence screen at this age, so stop kindly and praise the child's effort. Record the reading results on the **Reading front sheet** (the Early Reading Screen summary and the sentence reading results) and give it to the interviewer (Sections 5 and 6). Then take the movement break.

3.4 Writing (5 minutes, pages 12 and 13; given after maths)

Give the child a pencil. Do not spell any word, sound out, or write for the child.

Part 1: name (page 12). Point to the line next to "Name". Say: "Can you write your name here?" Record which script the child uses (English letters, pinyin or Chinese characters) on the grading sheet.

Part 2: five words (page 12). Say: "Now I will say some words. Write each word here. Listen to the sounds in the word. Have a go. It is fine if it is not right." For each word, point to the number, then say the word, the sentence and the word again, slowly and clearly (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2; do not stretch the sounds). Allow about 30 seconds; if nothing is written, say "That's fine. Next one."

No.	Say	Word	Spelling pattern
1	"sun. The sun is hot. sun."	sun	CVC
2	"fan. The fan goes round and round. fan."	fan	CVC
3	"pen. I can write with a pen. pen."	pen	CVC
4	"ship. The ship is on the sea. ship."	ship	digraph sh
5	"chop. Mum can chop the carrots. chop."	chop	digraph ch

None of the five words is on the reading cards, so the child has not just seen them written.

Part 3: a sentence about a picture (page 13). Point to the picture (a puppy in a box). Say: "Look at the picture. What can you see?" Let the child say it, and do not correct or improve their words. Then say: "Can you write about it? Write it here." If the child says they can't: "Have a go. Write the sounds you can hear." If the child writes one word, say once: "Can you write some more?" When they finish, say "Can you read it to me?" and write down what they say on the grading sheet: it helps you read their spelling.

Writing checklist. Record the name, handwriting and sentence checklist on the grading sheet, and for each of the five words whether it is correct, shows all the sounds ("fen", "shep", "chup"), some sounds ("sp", "c") or nothing.

Four criteria. Score each 0 to 4 (1 and 3 lie between the descriptions). Total: 16 marks.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	Nothing written, or marks not linked to the picture	One or two words or a phrase about the picture ("dog box")	A complete idea about the picture, perhaps with a second idea ("The dog is in the box. He is happy.")
Vocabulary	No English words	Simple nouns (dog, box)	Words chosen for meaning: puppy, sitting, happy, big, peeping
Grammar and sentences	No phrase or sentence	A phrase, or a sentence with words missing ("dog in box")	A simple sentence with a verb ("The dog is in the box."); may join two ideas with "and"
Spelling and punctuation (the five words and the sentence)	Random letters, or letters not linked to sounds	Most dictated words show some sounds, usually the first and last ("sn", "fn"); one or two words correct	All or nearly all dictated words correct or with all sounds shown, including sh and ch; a capital letter or a full stop in the sentence

Writing band (best fit with the descriptors; the totals are only a guide)

Band	Writing at age 5	Typical total
A	Makes marks, copies, or writes their name only; may write in Chinese; dictated words not attempted or random letters	0 to 3
B	Some letters match sounds (often first sounds); one or two dictated words with most sounds; a word or label for the picture	4 to 7
C	Most dictated words show most sounds and some are correct; a phrase or short sentence that can be read with help	8 to 10
D	Most dictated words correct; a simple sentence that another adult can read, with spaces between words	11 to 13
E	Comparable to a fluent English-speaking 5 year old (below)	14 to 16

What band E looks like at age 5. The child writes their name correctly (capital letter, then lower case), writes all five words correctly or with one small slip ("chopp"), and writes one or two simple sentences about the picture that another adult can read, with spaces between the words and usually a capital letter and a full stop. Most letters are correctly formed. This matches the end-of-Reception expectation (the Early Learning Goal for writing) for a fluent English speaker.

Spelling from children who speak Chinese

- Pinyin letter values often appear: "x" for sh ("xip" for ship), "q" or "c" for ch ("qop" for chop). Count these as "all sounds shown" and note them on the grading sheet: the child hears every sound but needs the English letters taught.
- Vowel swaps (e and a: "pan" for pen; u and a: "san" for sun) and missing final sounds ("pe", "cho") are features of a learner's English.
- Many Chinese kindergartens are asked not to teach formal writing, pinyin or characters before primary school, so letter writing **may not have been taught**. A blank page is not, on its own, a sign of a learning difficulty.

What to look for

- Strong: hears every sound in the CVC words, uses sh and ch, writes a sentence without help.
- English barrier: forms letters well and spells by sound, but writes the sentence in Chinese or pinyin. The child knows how to write, but not yet what to write in English.
- Note pencil grip and letter formation separately: fine motor control is not English.

4. Maths (12 minutes, student booklet pages 4 to 11)

Content: the end of Reception (Early Years goals). **Section A: Number problems** (items 1 to 8, 8 marks). **Section B: Word problems and pictures** (items 9 to 15, 7 marks, with 3 word problems: 11, 12 and 15). Total 15 marks.

How

- Put the pot of 20 counters on the table. Say: "Now let's play some number games. You can use these counters to help you."
- Read each question as written, slowly and clearly (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2). Then you may repeat it in English as often as needed, point to the picture and show with counters. A Chinese-speaking colleague may say it once in Chinese (mark **L**).
- The child answers by pointing, saying, showing fingers or moving counters. Number words must be in English; a child who cannot yet say the number may show it with fingers or counters, or point to it.
- Write 1 or 0 in the mark box on the child's page as you go, and NT or L beside the box (list the NT and L items on the grading sheet). Do not say whether an answer is right.
- Stop as in Section 2: three 0s in a row in Section A, go to Section B; three in a row in Section B, stop.

Section A: Number problems

No.	Say and do	Answer, and what else is acceptable	Notes
1	Point to the fish. "How many fish? Count them."	**7** (said in English, or shown with fingers or counters). A number said in Chinese scores 0.	Watch: touches each fish once; says the last number as the answer.
2	Before you say anything, cover all three dot cards with the plain card. "I will show you some dots very quickly. Tell me how many. Don't count, just look." Slide the card to show only the first dot card for about 2 seconds, then cover it again. Do the same with the second and then the third (cover the cards you are not showing with the card or your hand).	**3, 5, 4**. 1 mark for all three.	Two seconds is too short to count one by one, so quick correct answers show the child sees the amount.
3	Point to the number cards. "Point to 9." "Point to 15." Point to 12: "What number is this?" Point to 20: "What number is this?"	**9, 15**, "twelve", "twenty". 1 mark for all four. 十二 and 二十 count (L).	Common slips: 6 for 9, 13 for 15, "twenty" for 12. Note them.
4	Point to the stars. "How many stars? You can put a counter on each star."	**16** (said in English, or shown with counters). A number said in Chinese scores 0.	Counting past 10 accurately; watch for missed or double-counted stars.
5	Point to the 8 dots. "Here are 8 dots." Point to the dashed circle. "One more dot comes here. How many dots now?" You may put a counter in the circle.	**9**. Counting all from 1 or knowing straight away both score; note which.	"9!" straight away shows stronger number sense than counting from 1.
6	Point to the five frame. "This box has space for 5 dots. Here are 3 dots. How many more dots make 5?"	**2**. Pointing to the 2 empty squares and saying 2, or putting 2 counters in, scores.	Five frames may not have been taught.
7	Point to the ladybird. "This ladybird has 4 spots on this side (point) and 4 spots on this side (point). Double 4. How many spots altogether?"	**8**. Counting all scores.	The words "double" and "altogether" may not have been taught; the picture carries the meaning.
8	Point to the ten frame. "This box has space for 10 dots. Here are 7 dots. How many more dots make 10?"	**3**. Counters in the empty squares and counting score.	Number bonds to 10 may not have been taught.

Section B: Word problems and pictures (WP = word problem)

No.	Say and do	Answer, and what else is acceptable	Notes
9	Point to the pencils. "Point to the longer pencil." Point to the ribbons. "Point to the shorter ribbon."	The **bottom pencil**, then the **top ribbon**. 1 mark for both.	The longer pencil and the shorter ribbon are in different rows, so a child who always points to the same row will not score by chance.
10	"Point to the circle." "Point to the triangle." Point to the square: "What is this shape called?"	**circle, triangle**, "square". 1 mark for all three. 正方形 counts (L).	"Rectangle" for the square scores 0; note it.
11 WP	Point to the girl: "This is Mei." Point to the boy: "This is Jun." "Mei has 4 dumplings. Jun has 7 dumplings. Who has more dumplings?" (wait) "Who has fewer dumplings?"	**Jun**, then **Mei** (pointing to the child or the plate is fine). 1 mark for both.	If the child does not respond to "fewer", you may also ask "Who has less?"; note it.
12 WP	Point to the pond. "There are 7 ducks on the pond. 1 duck swims away. How many ducks are on the pond now?" The child may cover a duck with a finger or a counter.	**6**.	One less, in a story.
13	Point to the tree. "Point to the rabbit behind the tree." (wait) "Point to the rabbit in front of the tree."	**Behind**: the rabbit peeping out from behind the trunk (only its head, ears and a paw show). **In front**: the rabbit sitting against the bottom of the trunk. 1 mark for both.	The rabbit on the left is next to the tree: it is the other choice. Position words are taught in Chinese (前面, 后面, 旁边), so the English may be the only gap.
14	Run your finger along the row without naming the fruit. "Look at this pattern." Point to the question mark. "What comes next?" Point to the three pictures below: "This, this or this?"	**banana** (pointing to it, or saying "banana" or 香蕉, L).	Do not say the fruit names aloud: the sound of the pattern gives the answer away.
15 WP	Put 8 counters by the plates. "These are 8 biscuits. Mum puts them on 2 plates. Each plate has the same. How many biscuits are on each plate?"	**4**, with 4 counters on each plate. If the child shares correctly but does not say a number, ask "How many on this plate?" and accept the answer.	Watch the method: dealing one at a time, or guessing and fixing.

Band guide (provisional; review after the first 20 to 30 candidates)

Total	0 to 5	6 to 8	9 to 12	13 to 15
Band	1 Well below expected	2 Working towards	3 Expected	4 Greater depth

Number problems and word problems. Items 11, 12 and 15 use the same number ideas as Section A, but in English sentences. A child who does well on the number problems but poorly on the word problems may have an **English barrier rather than a maths difficulty**: check by reading the word problem aloud again, showing it with counters, and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, having it said once in Chinese (mark L). Record the result on the grading sheet.

Likely not yet taught

Chinese kindergartens are asked not to teach primary school content (the policy known as 去小学化), so what a child knows varies a lot; many children also go to extra classes. Ask the parent. A child who has finished the middle year (中班):

Item	May not have been taught
2	Quick recognition of dot patterns as a game, although dice are familiar
3, 4	Reading teen numbers; many kindergartens count to 20 aloud but read numerals only to 10
6, 8	Five and ten frames, and number bonds (数的分成, splitting 5 or 10 into two parts), which are usually taught in the top year (大班)
7	"Double" as a named idea
11	The English word "fewer" ("more" is usually known)
13	The English position words (the ideas are usually known in Chinese)
14	The English words "pattern" and "comes next" (repeating patterns, 找规律, are often met in kindergarten)
15	Sharing equally (平均分) as a named idea

What to look for

- How the child counts: touching each object, counting on from a number, or knowing at a glance. Confidence with numbers beyond 10.
- An English barrier looks like this: the child is lost at first, then answers quickly once you show it with counters or a colleague says it in Chinese. A maths difficulty looks like this: the child cannot do it even when the meaning is clear (for example, cannot count 7 objects reliably).
- Strong children often answer before you finish the question and use counters only to check.

5. Play-based interview and goodbye (6 minutes, page 14)

The questions are in `forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y1_Y2` and the record is the Interview sheet (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y1_Y2`). Sit on the floor or at the low table, open the student booklet at page 14 (Draw) and offer the crayons: the interview starts with a drawing ("Can you draw you, doing something you love?"). Play alongside, talk about the drawing and follow the child's lead. Give the speaking band on the Interview sheet, combining the interview with the picture talk (recorded on the grading sheet). The observation boxes on the Interview sheet cover the whole visit, so fill them in now.

Goodbye. Say: "Thank you, [name]! You worked really hard today. I liked [something specific, such as your drawing or your counting]. Let's go and find Mum (or Dad)." Do not give any results to the family on the day.

6. Recording the results

1. Mark the student booklet the same day (every maths question has a mark box).
2. Copy the totals onto the grading sheet and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance).
3. Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet (the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen, guide section 6.7).
4. Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet before the interview.
5. After the interview, put together the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days.
6. File the marked student booklet with them (or shred it under the school's policy).

Interviewer guide: Years 1 and 2

This guide is reusable. Nothing is written on it: keep one in the room, in a folder or laminated. Ratings and notes for each child go on the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y1_Y2`).

About 6 minutes, 1:1, play-based. Most of what you need about a 5 or 6 year old comes from watching them during the whole visit, not from questions. This short chat, at the end of the visit, is **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the child's spoken English, to get to know the child (likes, family, friends, **what they want to be**), and to judge their readiness for the international programme. Use the list in Section 3 for the whole visit, and tick it on the Interview sheet. The sentence reading is not part of this chat: in Years 1 to 3 the assessor runs the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`) after the Early Reading Screen and writes the points on the Reading front sheet.

How to do it. Sit on the floor or at a low table beside the child. Offer paper and crayons: "Can you draw you, doing something you love?" Talk about the drawing. Ask the main question first; if the child does not answer, use the **easier** prompt (a choice, a yes or no, or "show me"). Wait. Praise effort. Never press a child who is upset; stop and let them go back to their parent.

Pace of speech. Speak slowly and clearly: short phrases, with a pause after each. Use the same pace for every candidate in the year group. Do not rush: wait at least five seconds before rephrasing.

Safeguarding. A young child is never alone with one adult behind a closed door. If a child says something that worries you, write down their words and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Questions

On the Interview sheet, write short notes under "Key things the student said" (their own words, and how they said it), and a line about the drawing.

Topic	Main question	Easier
Me	What is your name? How old are you?	Show me with your fingers.
	Tell me about your picture.	Is this you? What are you doing?
Family	Who lives at your home?	Do you have a brother? A sister? A pet?
Likes	What do you like to play?	Do you like to run? Draw? Play with blocks?
	What is your favourite food? Favourite animal?	Do you like noodles? Do you like cats?
School	Tell me about your school (or kindergarten).	Do you like it? What do you do there?
	Who are your friends?	Do you play with friends?
Feelings	What makes you happy?	Are you happy today? (point to a happy or sad face)
When I grow up	What do you want to be when you grow up?	A teacher? A doctor? A footballer?
Here	Would you like to come to this school? What would you like to do here?	Do you want to play here? Learn English here?

2. Speaking band

Choose the band that fits best, for a child of this age, and tick it on the Interview sheet. Rate **listening in conversation** with the same letters.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	No English yet, or one or two words. Uses Chinese, pointing or silence. May copy a word you say.
B Early acquisition	Single words and short phrases ("cat", "my mummy", "I like red"). Understands simple questions with gesture or pictures.
C Developing competence	Short sentences about familiar things ("I play with my friend"), with errors. Understands most simple questions.
D Competent	Talks in sentences, tells you about the picture or a simple event, joins ideas with "and" or "because".
E Fluent	Talks as a fluent English-speaking child of 5 or 6 would.

3. What to look for during the whole visit

Tick what you saw on the Interview sheet, and add a note.

- Separates from the parent without great distress, or settles within a few minutes
- Joins in the activities and stays with each one for a few minutes
- Follows a simple instruction (with gesture if needed)
- Holds a pencil or crayon with control; draws a person with several parts
- Takes turns, shares, waits
- Shows curiosity: looks, touches, asks, explores
- Copies new English words, or tries to
- Recovers when something is hard or when they do not understand
- Uses the toilet, coat and shoes independently (ask the parent)

4. Readiness

Rate each strand on the Interview sheet: **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or what you saw.

Strand	What strong looks like at this age
Attitude to learning	Enjoys the activities, has a go, pleased with success
Curiosity and engagement	Interested, explores, asks questions
Social and emotional readiness	Settles with new adults, manages separation, plays alongside or with others
Independence	Manages simple tasks and self-care for age
Kindness and conduct	Gentle, polite, shares
Readiness for learning in English	Happy in an English-speaking setting, tries words, is not distressed by not understanding

5. Anything to follow up

Tick any that apply on the Interview sheet, and add a note:

- Speech and language (for example very little speech in Chinese as well as English, unclear speech for age)
- Attention, hearing, vision, movement or fine motor skills
- Wellbeing (for example very anxious, very tired)
- Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)
- Medical or dietary

Speech in Chinese. Ask the parent how the child speaks in Chinese (Parent Conversation Record, Section 4). A child with little English but age-appropriate Chinese is a typical English learner. A child who also has very little speech in Chinese for their age may need a speech and language check: raise it with the parent gently, as a question rather than a conclusion.

Receiving homeroom teacher (optional). If the likely homeroom teacher meets the child, they note first impressions and what the child would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy, picture cards for routines, a familiar comfort object, a gradual start) on the Interview sheet.

To finish. On the Interview sheet, write your comment for the final mark sheet (strengths, concerns, support), and sign and date it.

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: interviewer guide

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 12. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this guide (the sentences are in Section 5), the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`), a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening). This guide is reusable: nothing is written on it. Write every point, meaning mark, total and result on the Reading front sheet.

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	9	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25	25	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

Pace of speech. When you give the instructions and ask the meaning questions, speak slowly and clearly, especially with the younger students. Use a short pause after each sentence, and a longer one with the younger students. Use the same pace for every candidate in a year group, and do not rush.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said on the Reading front sheet. Patterns (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in Section 5), at the pace described in Section 1. Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Mark ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood) on the Reading front sheet. The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is marked ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**, and write the rating on the Reading front sheet.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Interviewer's copy of the sentences

The student reads from the card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`). Follow this copy as they read, and write the points (2, 1 or 0 for each sentence), the meaning mark and the level total on the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

No.	Sentence (Level 1)
1	I can see a red bus.
2	The cat sat on my bed.
3	Dad has a big hat.
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*

No.	Sentence (Level 2)
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.
6	They like to play in the park.
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*

No.	Sentence (Level 3)
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*

No.	Sentence (Level 4)
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*

No.	Sentence (Level 5)
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*

No.	Sentence (Level 6)
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*

No.	Sentence (Level 7)
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*

No.	Sentence (Level 8)
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*

No.	Sentence (Level 9)
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*

No.	Sentence (Level 10)
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*

No.	Sentence (Level 11)
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*

No.	Sentence (Level 12)
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Write on the Reading front sheet: total points, reading age, actual age (years:months), the difference (reading age minus actual age), meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓) and fluency rating (1 to 4).

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 12 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 12
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Write on the Reading front sheet: the indicative band, and one line on patterns noticed.

Early Reading Screen: instructions

What it is. A one-to-one reading screen for children joining **Years 1 to 3**, and for an **older student who is new to English**. It shows where the child's **decoding** is (letter sounds, phonics, tricky words) and the **book band** they can read with understanding. It takes **about 10 to 12 minutes** at most; the start points keep it shorter for most children. All of it is in English: finding the child's level of English reading is one of its main purposes. The year group assessor instructions say where to start; the results go on the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`) and the final mark sheet.

What to print

- **Reading cards** (`Early_Reading_Screen_Cards`): once, in plastic sleeves. The child reads from these.
- **Instructions** (this guide, `Early_Reading_Screen_Guide`): once, for the assessor's folder.
- **Record sheets** (`Early_Reading_Screen_Record`, Sheets 1 to 13): one set for each child. You only need the running record sheets for the passages you use.

1. At a glance

Part	Cards	What the child does	About	Score
1 Letter sounds	1, 2	Says the sound of 26 single letters, then 18 letter groups (sh, ai, igh ...).	2 min	/ 26 and / 18
2 Phonics words	3 (practice), 4 to 7	Reads 40 words. **Section 1** (words 1 to 20): single letters, consonant digraphs, adjacent consonants (CVC, CCVC, CVCC). **Section 2** (words 21 to 40): vowel digraphs and trigraphs, split digraphs, two-syllable words. In each section 10 are real words and 10 are creature names (nonsense words).	3 min	/ 20 and / 20
3 Tricky words	8	Reads 20 common exception words: 10 from the Year 1 list and 10 from the Year 2 list.	1 min	/ 20
4 Passages	9 to 16	Reads two or three short stories aloud while you take a running record, then answers 3 or 4 questions on each.	4 to 6 min	book band
Total		Not every child does every part (Section 2).	**10 to 12 min**	

You need: the reading cards; one set of record sheets; a pencil; a watch; a plain card to cover lines if the child finds a full card too busy; a levelled book from the school's assessment set (optional, see 5.5).

2. Start points, stopping rules and timing

Where to start

Child	Start with	Then
Year 1 (age 5)	Letter sounds: Card 1, then Card 2 if 15 or more of Card 1 are right.	Section 1 (practice Card 3, then Cards 4 and 5). Section 2 (Cards 6 and 7) only if Section 1 is 15 or more. Tricky words (Card 8). Passages: see "Which passage first".
Year 2 (age 6)	Section 1, words 1 to 10 (practice Card 3, then Card 4).	**If words 1 to 10 are easy** (9 or 10 right, most read without sounding out): skip the letter sounds. Do words 11 to 20, then Section 2 if Section 1 is 15 or more, then the tricky words and passages. **If not:** finish Section 1 (and Section 2 if Section 1 is 15 or more), then do the letter sounds, the tricky words and the passages.
Year 3 (age 7)	Section 1, words 1 to 10.	**If easy:** go straight to Section 2 (skip words 11 to 20 and the letter sounds). Section 2 is 15 or more: go on to the passages. Section 2 is 12 to 14: tricky words, then passages. Section 2 is under 12: go back to words 11 to 20, then tricky words and passages. **If not easy:** as Year 2.
Older student new to English (age 8 or more)	Letter sounds (Cards 1 and 2) and Section 1.	Section 2 if Section 1 is 15 or more. Tricky words. Passages if Section 1 is 8 or more. Their reading band comes from their year group's reading paper; this screen shows where their decoding is, for planning.

Words skipped by a start rule are not scored: write "start rule" across them, and record the section as, for example, "10 / 10 on words 1 to 10, start rule".

Which passage first

Phonics result	First passage
Section 1 under 8	None. The book band is "not yet Pink". Stop after the tricky words.
Section 1 8 to 15	Passage 1, Pink (Card 9)
Section 1 16 or more, and Section 2 under 8 or not given	Passage 2, Red (Card 10)
Section 2 8 to 13	Passage 3, Yellow (Card 11)
Section 2 14 to 17	Passage 4, Light Blue (Card 12)
Section 2 18 or more	Passage 5, Green (Card 13). Year 3 and older: Passage 6, Orange (Card 14).

Moving between passages

- **A pass** is 90% accuracy or more **and** at least half the questions right (2 of 3, or 2 of 4).
- After a pass, give the next passage up. Stop at the first passage that is not a pass.
- If the first passage is not a pass, go down one passage (not below Passage 1).
- Use two or three passages. Give a fourth only if the child is keen and there is time.
- **The child's book band level is the highest passage passed.** Also note the highest passage read at 90% or more, if it is higher (decoding ahead of understanding, 6.3).

Stopping rules

Part	Stop when
Letter sounds	6 wrong in a row. Then say: "Look at the rest. Point to any you know." Mark the ones the child points to and says correctly.
Phonics words	5 wrong in a row in a section. The rest of that section scores 0.
Tricky words	5 wrong in a row.
A passage	The child goes past the "too hard" number of errors before the end, or is stuck on most lines. Say: "Thank you. You worked hard on that one." It is not a pass.
The whole screen	About 12 minutes, or the child is tired, upset or asks to stop. Record it on the summary sheet.

Timing

- Letter sounds about 2 minutes, phonics words about 3, tricky words about 1, passages and questions about 4 to 6.
- Write the start and finish times on the summary sheet (Sheet 13). Do not time the reading for a score; note it only if it is very slow.
- If the child is tiring, finish the passage you are on and stop. A short break and a return later is fine; record it.

3. Before you start

Setting up

- A quiet room. Sit side by side at a table. The card the child needs is in front of them; the record sheets are on a clipboard, out of the child's sight.
- Give this screen after the picture talk and listening (see the order of the day in the year group booklet). By then you have heard the child's spoken English, which helps you judge accent (4.4).
- Turn the cards yourself. Point to each item as the child reads it, or let the child point.

Access rules for this screen (the same in every year group)

- Say only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate, sound out, or read the cards or passages aloud.
- The child may ask for an instruction to be repeated in English. Repeat it as written.
- Everything is in English: letters, words and passages are read in English, and the answers to the questions about a passage must be in English. An answer in Chinese scores 0.
- Praise effort, never answers: "Thank you." "You are working hard." Do not say "good", "right" or "no" after a word.
- The child may stop a part when they have done what they can. Never push a distressed child: take a break or stop, and record it.
- Extra time or other arrangements for a known need: record them on the summary sheet.

Say at the start: "Now we are going to do some reading. Some of it is easy and some of it is hard. That is fine. Just do your best."

4. Marking conventions for learners of English

4.1 The main rule

> **Mark the reading, not the accent.** A word is right when a listener who can see the text would know which word the child said. Many children joining from Chinese schools speak English with features of Mandarin pronunciation. These are part of their spoken English, not reading errors, unless they change the word.

4.2 These are errors (each one counts 1)

Error	What the child does	Example	Mark
S Substitution	Says a different word, or a word that is not real.	"big" read as "bag"; "went" read as "want"; "strong" read as "string"	Write what the child said above the word.
O Omission	Leaves out a word, or leaves off an ending that is written (-s or -ed). This counts even if the child leaves endings off when they speak, as in the Graded Sentence Reading Screen; note the pattern.	"a big green kite" read as "a green kite"; "kicked" read as "kick"	Circle the word or ending.
I Insertion	Adds a word that is not there.	"on the mat" read as "on the big mat"	Write ^ and the added word.
T Told	Is stuck. You wait about 5 seconds, then say the word.		Write T above the word.

An error counts each time it happens, except a **name**: count a name error once in each passage, however often it comes.

4.3 These are not errors

Not an error	Example	Mark
SC Self-correction: the child reads a word wrongly, then puts it right.	"bag … big"	Write what was said, then SC.
R Repetition of a word or phrase.	"the cat … the cat is on the mat"	Underline the repeated words, write R.
Sounding out, then the right word.	"s-t-u-ck, stuck"	Nothing.
Pausing, reading slowly.		Nothing: it shows in the fluency rating.
l and r	"led" for red, "lain" for rain	acc
n and l	"nong" for long	acc
v and w	"wan" for van	acc
th said as s, f, d or z	"sank you" for thank you, "fink" for think, "dis" for this	acc
A dropped, quiet or unreleased final consonant sound, when the rest of the word is right (not a written ending such as -s or -ed: see Omission)	"be(d)", "do(g)", "stam(p)"	acc
A small vowel added after a final consonant	"bed-uh", "dog-uh", "kite-uh"	acc
The -ed ending said in full	"kick-ed" for kicked	acc
A short vowel said a little long or tense, when it is still clearly that vowel and the child gave the English sound on Card 1	"sit" a little like "seet"	acc
A name read in a Chinese or English way	Hao, Jun, Shanghai, Liu	Nothing.
A whole line missed (the child lost their place)		Point to the line: "Try this line." Mark the words as usual. The skip is not an error.

4.4 When you are not sure

Ask yourself two questions:

1. Would a listener who can see the text know which word the child said?
2. Does the child say this sound the same way when they talk (in the picture talk, for example)?

Two yeses: it is accent. Count it right and write **acc**. Otherwise count it as an error and write down what you heard. If you are still not sure, give the benefit of the doubt and make a note: patterns across many words are more useful than any one word.

4.5 Pinyin letter values (P)

A child who learnt pinyin may give an English letter its pinyin value. This is not guessing: the child is using a letter-sound system they know well. **Write P** above the letter or word, and what you heard.

Letters	English sound	Pinyin value the child may give	Example
i	short i, as in "sit"	"ee"	"sit" read as "seat"
u	short u, as in "up"	"oo"	"mub" read as "moob"
e	short e, as in "leg"	the pinyin e, like the vowel in "her"	"leg" read as "lerg"
o	short o, as in "on"	"aw" or "wo"	"dop" read as "dwop"
ai	as in "rain"	"eye"	"rain" read as "rine"
c	"k"	"ts"	"cake" read as "tsake"
x	"ks"	a soft "sh"	"x" said as "sh"; "six" read as "sish"
q, qu	"kw"	a soft "ch"	"qu" said as "chu"
z	"z"	"dz" or "ts"	"z" said as "dz"
j, r, h	as in "jam", "red", "hat"	close to the pinyin values	Accept: not P.
b, d, g, m and the other consonants	the sound alone	the sound with a vowel after it: "bo", "de", "ge" (from learning pinyin)	Accept: not P.

How P is scored

- **Letter sounds, phonics words and tricky words:** P scores 0, because the child did not give the English sound. Count the Ps separately: they show a working sound system that needs the English values (6.5).
- **Passages:** use the main rule. If the word is still clear in the sentence ("six eggs" read as "sish eggs"), it is not an error: write P only. If the word is not clear, it is an error: write P and what you heard.

4.6 Marks to use

Mark	Meaning	Counts as an error?
nothing, or a tick	read correctly	no
the word the child said, written above (S)	substitution	yes
circle (O)	omission	yes
^ and the word (I)	insertion	yes
T	told by you after about 5 seconds	yes
A	appeal: the child asked for help, and you said "Try it."	no, unless it ends in T
SC	self-correction	no
R	repetition	no
acc	accent feature; the word is clear	no
P	pinyin letter value	letters, phonics words, tricky words: yes. Passages: only if the word is not clear
N	letter name instead of the sound (letter sounds only)	yes
SO	sounds only: the child said the sounds but did not blend them (phonics words)	yes
RW	a creature word read as a real word ("blom" read as "bloom")	yes

5. Scripts and scoring

5.1 Letter sounds (Cards 1 and 2)

Card 1. Say: "Look at these letters. Tell me the sound each letter makes." Point to the first letter. "What sound does this one make?"

- Point to each letter in turn, along each row.
- **If the child says the letter name** (the first time only): "Yes, that is its name. What sound does it make?" After that, mark N for a name and move on.
- **If the child does not know** after about 5 seconds: "That is fine. Next one."
- **Stop** after 6 wrong in a row. Say: "Look at the rest. Point to any you know."

Card 2 (only if 15 or more right on Card 1). **Say:** "These letters go together. They make one sound. Tell me the sound." Point to each in turn.

Accept	Do not accept
The common English sound: a as in "ant", e as in "egg", i as in "ink", o as in "on", u as in "up"; c and k as "k"; g as in "go"; q as "kw" (or "k"); x as "ks"; y as in "yes". A consonant sound with a small vowel after it ("buh", "bo"). Accent features (4.3), such as v said close to w.	A letter name (N). A pinyin value (P). The sound of a different letter. A long vowel for a single vowel letter ("ay" for a): that is the name, mark N.
Card 2: sh as in "ship"; ch as in "chin"; th as in "thin" or "this" (a single s, f or d sound is accent: accept); ng as in "ring"; ck "k"; qu "kw"; ai as in "rain"; ee as in "see"; igh as in "night"; oa as in "boat"; oo as in "moon" or "book"; ar as in "car"; or as in "for"; ur as in "fur"; ow as in "cow" or "snow"; oi as in "coin"; ear as in "near"; air as in "fair".	Two separate sounds ("s-h", "o-a"). Letter names ("s, h"). A pinyin value ("ai" as "eye", mark P).

5.2 Phonics words (Cards 3 to 7)

Card 3 (practice). Point to **hat**. **Say:** "Now we are going to read some words. This is a real word. Can you read it?" If the child cannot, say: "It says hat."

Point to the big creature, then to **jop**. **Say:** "Look. This is a creature. This word has a creature next to it, so it is the creature's name. It says jop. Creature names are not real words."

Say: "Some words are real words. Some words are creature names. Read them the best you can."

Card 4. Say: "Now read these words to me. Start here." Point to word 1, then to each word in turn along each row (the grey numbers match the record sheet). Turn to Card 5 after word 10.

Card 6 (Section 2). **Say:** "Here are some more words. Some are real words and some are creature names. Read them the best you can."

- If the child says nothing for about 5 seconds: "That is fine. Next one." Do not tell the word.
- The child may sound out. Score the word they blend in the end. Write what the child said for every word that scores 0.

Scoring: 1 for each word read correctly. Accent features score 1 (4.3). Pinyin values (P), sounds only (SO) and creature words read as real words (RW) score 0. A real word must be read as that word. A creature word scores 1 for any reading that fits its letters, including these:

Creature word	Accept
thep	th as in "thin" or as in "this"
chulp	"ch" as in "chin"
jeek	rhymes with "seek"
toap	rhymes with "soap"
darp, sorp	with or without an r sound at the end of the vowel
choil	rhymes with "boil"
jeme	"jeem"
plome	rhymes with "home"
flape	rhymes with "tape"
lompid	"lom-pid", stress on either part
shoomit	"shoo-mit"; oo as in "moon" or as in "book"

5.3 Tricky words (Card 8)

Say: "These are words you might know. Read them to me." Point to each word in turn.

- If the child does not know after about 5 seconds: "That is fine. Next one."
- 1 for each word read correctly within about 5 seconds. Sounding out that ends with the right word is fine. A word sounded out as it is spelt ("was" read to rhyme with "has") scores 0.
- Stop after 5 wrong in a row.
- Words 1 to 10 are from the Year 1 list of common exception words and words 11 to 20 from the Year 2 list (English National Curriculum, spelling appendix).

5.4 Passages (Cards 9 to 16)

Each passage is matched to a book band and an Oxford Level (the levels used for Oxford Reading Tree books), so a real levelled book at the same level can be used in its place (5.5).

Passage	Card	Title	Book band	Oxford Level	Words	Independent: errors at most	Pass (90%): errors at most	Pass: questions at least
1	9	Where Is the Cat?	Pink	1+	23	1	2	2 of 3
2	10	At the Market	Red	2	36	1	3	2 of 3
3	11	The Kite	Yellow	3	57	2	5	2 of 4
4	12	A New Friend	Light Blue	4	79	3	7	2 of 4
5	13	The Lucky Dumpling	Green	5	99	4	9	2 of 4
6	14	The Fast Train	Orange	6	126	6	12	2 of 4
7	15	The Rabbit Lantern	Turquoise and Purple	7 to 8	151	7	15	2 of 4
8	16	The Drummer	Gold and White	9 to 10	178	8	17	2 of 4

1. Choose the first passage from Section 2. Put its card in front of the child.
2. **Say** the introduction printed on the passage's record sheet: the title and one sentence about the story. This is the only text you read aloud. The title does not count in the word count.
3. While the child reads, mark the running record (4.6). You do not need to tick every word: mark only what is different.
4. If the child stops or asks for help, say: "Try it." If the child is still stuck after about 5 seconds, say the word and mark T.
5. When the child finishes, **say:** "Thank you. Now I will ask you some questions about the story. You can look at the story." Ask each question as written. You may repeat a question once. If an answer is too short to judge, you may say once: "Tell me more."
6. Score the accuracy, self-corrections, fluency and questions on the sheet. Decide whether it is a pass and move up or down (Section 2).

Accuracy = (words minus errors) ÷ words × 100. Each sheet has the table already worked out.

Accuracy	Level	What it means
95% or more	Independent (Ind)	The child can read books at this band on their own.
90 to 94%	Instructional (Ins)	The right level for teaching, with support.
Below 90%	Too hard	Not a pass, whatever the questions show.

Self-correction rate = (errors + self-corrections) ÷ self-corrections, written as 1 : the answer. For example, 6 errors and 2 SC: 8 ÷ 2 = 4, so 1 : 4. A rate of 1 : 3 or better (1 : 1, 1 : 2, 1 : 3) shows a child who checks their reading. No SC: write "none".

Fluency (rate the whole passage)

Rating		What it sounds like
1	Word by word	One word at a time, with long pauses. No sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Some phrasing	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word by word. Little attention to punctuation. Little expression.
3	Mostly phrased	Reads in sensible phrases and mostly follows full stops and commas. Some pauses to work out harder words.
4	Fluent and expressive	Smooth and close to natural speech. Follows punctuation. The voice changes for questions and for what characters say.

Questions: 1 mark each. The child may look back at the story. Accept answers in the child's own words, one word, or a short phrase; grammar mistakes do not matter. Pointing counts only where the question asks the child to show. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Book band level = the highest passage read at **90% or more** with **at least half the questions** right.

5.5 Using a real levelled book instead

- You may use a real levelled book at the same band instead of a passage, for example an Oxford Reading Tree book from the school's assessment set. The book list is in `01_Reading_Books_and_Materials.md`.
- Choose a book the child has not read. Ask: "Have you read this book before?"
- Use the same method: introduce it with the title and one sentence, then use the same marks, error rules, accuracy levels, self-correction rate and fluency scale.
- Pink to Yellow: use the whole book. Light Blue and above: use a section of about 100 to 150 words, and count the words before you start.
- Use **Sheet 12**. Before you start, write 3 or 4 questions (literal, inference, vocabulary, and prediction or personal response) and the answers you expect. A pass is the same: 90% or more and at least half the questions.
- Write the book's title, band and Oxford Level on the summary sheet.

6. What the results mean

6.1 Is decoding secure?

Result	What it suggests
Card 1: 24 or more / 26; Card 2: 15 or more / 18	Letter-sound knowledge is secure.
Card 1: 10 to 23	Partly secure. List the letters missed: they show what to teach first.
Section 1: 16 or more / 20	Blending is secure with single letters, consonant digraphs and adjacent consonants.
Section 1: under 12	Blending is not yet secure. The child needs phonics teaching from the early stages.
Section 2: 14 or more / 20	Vowel digraphs and split digraphs are mostly secure.
Section 1 secure, Section 2 under 10	Single letters and blends are secure; vowel digraphs and split digraphs are not yet. Typical of a fluent English reader partway through Reception.
Both sections secure	Decoding is secure for Key Stage 1 phonics. The next limit is vocabulary and understanding: look at the passages.
Tricky words: 8 or more of the Year 1 words (or of the Year 2 words)	The common exception words for that year are known by sight.

6.2 Real words and nonsense words

- **Real words much higher than nonsense words** (3 or more higher in a section): the child may be reading known words by sight, or guessing from the first letter. Decoding of new words is weaker than it looks. Check the passages for guesses that fit the picture or the meaning but not the letters.

- **Nonsense words about the same as, or higher than, real words:** decoding is working. Low real-word scores then often mean the child does not know these English words, so they cannot check them against meaning: a vocabulary gap, not a phonics gap.
- **Many RW** (creature words turned into real words): the child expects reading to make sense, which is good, but does not yet trust their decoding.
- **Many SO** (sounds only): the child knows the sounds but cannot yet blend them. Teach blending.

6.3 Decoding and understanding

Pattern	What it suggests	What to record
Accuracy 95% or more, but fewer than half the questions right	**Decoding ahead of understanding.** The child can say the words but does not yet understand enough English. Common in children taught phonics in after-school classes.	The book band level is the level with understanding. Also record "decodes at" the highest passage read at 90% or more. The need is vocabulary and spoken English.
Accuracy below 90%, but most questions right	**Understanding ahead of decoding.** Spoken English and meaning are strong; decoding is behind. Often a child from a bilingual school taught whole words, or a confident speaker who uses the pictures and the meaning.	The book band level is lower than the child's understanding. The need is systematic phonics; progress is often quick.
Low accuracy and few questions right	The passage is too hard.	The level below is the book band level.

6.4 Vocabulary gaps

- The child reads a word correctly but cannot say what it means (a vocabulary question wrong).
- Substitutions that look like the word but do not make sense ("strong" read as "string", "shiny" read as "shy").
- Note the words the child did not know. They show what to teach, and they are evidence for the reading band.

6.5 Patterns typical for children who learnt pinyin

- **Strong blending of short words:** pinyin is spelt sound by sound, so blending transfers well.
- **Pinyin vowel values:** i as "ee", u as "oo", e as the pinyin e, ai as "eye" ("rain" read as "rine").
- **Pinyin consonant values:** c as "ts", q as "ch", x as "sh", z as "dz".
- **A vowel added to consonant sounds** ("bo", "de"), from the way pinyin is taught. Not an error.
- **Letter names known, sounds not known** (many N marks): the child learnt the alphabet song but not phonics.
- **Split digraphs and silent letters are new:** pinyin has no silent letters, so "cake" may be read as "cak" or "ca-ke".
- **English vowel digraphs** (ee, oa, oo, igh) are new, and may be read as two sounds.
- **Final consonants dropped or softened:** Mandarin syllables end only in a vowel, n or ng. This is accent (4.3).
- These children already know that letters stand for sounds, so they usually respond well to direct teaching of the English values.

6.6 Book bands: what a fluent English reader usually reads

These are **Oxford's guide figures for fluent English readers** (Oxford levelling guidance: end of Reception Oxford Level 3, end of Year 1 Level 6, end of Year 2 Level 10, end of Year 3 Level 13). Oxford says the chart is a guide only, and schools vary. **Most children joining from Chinese schools will read below these bands at entry. That is expected**, and it is what the A to E band in 6.7 takes into account: the band describes how far the child's English reading has come, compared with these figures.

Point in the school year	Age (about)	Book band	Oxford Level	Phonics on this screen
Start of Year 1	5	Yellow	3	Letter sounds and Section 1 mostly secure; some of Section 2
Start of Year 2	6	Orange	6	Sections 1 and 2 mostly secure
Start of Year 3	7	White	10	Secure; tricky words known
Start of Year 4	8	Lime and above	11 and above	Secure. Beyond the top of this screen (Passage 8 is Gold and White).

Oxford Levels and book bands, for matching a real book: 1 Lilac, 1+ Pink, 2 Red, 3 Yellow, 4 Light Blue, 5 Green, 6 Orange, 7 Turquoise, 8 Purple, 9 Gold, 10 White, 11 Lime.

6.7 Band guide: the reading band A to E

Use the column for the year group the child is joining. "Passage" means the book band level: the highest passage passed (5.4). Band E means comparable to a fluent English reader of the same age, so it is set at the Oxford figures in 6.6.

Reading band	Age 5, joining Year 1 (fluent readers: about Yellow)	Age 6, joining Year 2 (fluent readers: about Orange)	Age 7, joining Year 3 (fluent readers: about White)
A New to English	Fewer than 10 letter sounds; reads no words.	Fewer than 10 letter sounds, or fewer than 4 Section 1 words.	Fewer than 8 Section 1 words; no passage.
B Early acquisition	10 or more letter sounds; reads 1 to 9 Section 1 words.	4 or more Section 1 words but no passage; or Passage 1 (Pink).	8 or more Section 1 words but no passage; or Passage 1, 2 or 3 (Pink, Red, Yellow).
C Developing competence	Section 1: 10 or more but no passage; or Passage 1 (Pink).	Passage 2 or 3 (Red, Yellow).	Passage 4 or 5 (Light Blue, Green).
D Competent	Passage 2 (Red).	Passage 4 or 5 (Light Blue, Green).	Passage 6 or 7 (Orange; Turquoise and Purple).
E Fluent	Passage 3 (Yellow) or above.	Passage 6 (Orange) or above.	Passage 8 (Gold and White).

- **E also needs reading that sounds fluent for the age:** fluency 3 or 4 and most of the questions right at that level. If not, give D.
- **Best fit, not a formula.** If the results are uneven (for example Passage 4 passed with very few letter sounds known), use judgement and say why in the notes. Check against the Graded Sentence Reading Screen and the listening and speaking bands.
- **Joining later in the school year:** expect a little more for D and E, about one passage higher by the second half of the year.
- **An older student new to English:** this screen only finds the floor. As a guide: below Pink, A; Pink to Yellow, B; Light Blue to Orange, C. If they pass Passage 7 or 8, their band comes from the year group's reading paper. Use the letter sound and phonics results to plan teaching.